

launched. Created by Sumlock-Comptometer Ltd, it was first available in Britain. It used vacuum tubes and could perform the four basic arithmetic operations with a 8-digit input limit .



Anita made your tax calculations easier

November: Time-sharing

The Compatible Time Sharing System (CTSS) was created by Fernando Corbato. This allowed an entirely different means of interacting with a computer, which till then would operate in batch mode and could not be interrupted till all the steps of one batch were complete. Time-sharing enabled a computer to serve many users simultaneously. A time-sharing computer stops a job, transfers the relevant data to a different location, runs something else, and then resumes the previous job, thereby sharing the computer's processing time between all users. (It is worthwhile to remember that the reference to a computer in 1961 usually means a mainframe computer, which usually serves many users.) This also made the computer more interactive, since it could now respond to users' commands almost instantaneously. (Present-day computers also use concepts of the CTSS in the form of "interrupts," which allows a PC to multitask.) The CTSS led to the Advanced Research Projects Agency (ARPA)-funded project to create a full-fledged time-sharing system, named the Multiplexed Information and Computer System, or Multics.

The DBMS

The first database management system was created by Charles Bachman to support GE's manufacturing information system. The Integrated Data Store (IDS) database management system was the code of the system. It has many firsts to its credit : the first disk-based DBMS, at a time when punch cards were in vogue; the concept of "virtual memory" to differentially store permanent and dynamic data; and it also used a buffer to store recently-accessed data.